

FASHION DESIGN AND GARMENT MAKING

TOPIC 1: Introduction to Garment Making

Garment making is the process of designing and constructing clothing. It is important for clothing the body, self-employment and the fashion industry. Career opportunities include fashion designer, tailor/seamstress, pattern maker, fashion illustrator, boutique owner and costume designer.

TOPIC 2: Sewing Tools and Equipment

Tools: measuring tape, scissors (dressmaking and paper), pins, needles, thimble, seam ripper, chalk/marker, ruler, French curve. Equipment: sewing machine, iron, ironing board, dress form. Care: keep tools clean, sharp and in a tool box; oil the machine as required.

TOPIC 3 & 4: Sewing Machine – Parts and Functions

A sewing machine stitches fabric using a needle and thread. Types: manual (hand/treadle) and electric. Main parts: needle, presser foot, bobbin and bobbin case, thread take-up lever, stitch length dial, hand wheel, foot pedal (electric). Operate only after proper threading and with the presser foot down; practise on scrap fabric first.

TOPIC 5: Handling and Maintenance

Clean lint regularly, oil moving parts as directed, change needles when blunt, cover the machine when not in use, and store in a dry place. Never force the hand wheel if the machine is stuck.

TOPIC 6: Basic Sewing Techniques (Hand Stitches)

- Running stitch – simple temporary or permanent stitch
- Tacking (basting) – temporary long stitches to hold fabric
- Hemming – neat finish on edges of garments
- Overcasting – prevents fraying of raw edges
- Back stitch – strong permanent stitch

TOPIC 7: Fibres and Fabrics

Fibres are the raw materials of fabrics. Natural fibres: cotton, linen, wool, silk. Synthetic fibres: polyester, nylon, acrylic, rayon. Fabrics are made by weaving, knitting or bonding fibres. Choice of fabric depends on the garment, climate and care requirements.

TOPIC 8: Fabric Identification

Methods: touch (feel), sight (appearance), and burn test (natural fibres burn differently from synthetics – with care and supervision). Knowing the fabric helps in choosing the right needle, thread and care method.

TOPIC 9: Simple Garment Sketching

Freehand sketching uses basic shapes (lines, ovals, rectangles) to represent the human body and clothes. Practise drawing simple dresses, shirts and trousers to communicate design ideas.

Summary

Garment making involves tools, the sewing machine, basic stitches, knowledge of fibres and fabrics, and simple design sketching. Good care of equipment and practice build useful vocational skills.

End of Fashion Design First Term Notes